

Super Computers!

Linux dominates super computing. It occupies 470 of the top 500 spots. The remaining: 25 with Unix, mainly AIX, and Windows with only 5

Still no "year of Desktop Linux"?

Windows 7 took 4 days to have more market share than all distributions of Linux combined

DIY



Get your own Linux distro on a flash drive and use it on PCs as you travel around. We show you how could stay up and running with your data no matter where you are

Linux on a Flash Drive

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We know you've always wanted a full Linux operating system on a USB thumb drive. But the problem was that most of the tools only made a non-persistent installation that worked like a Live CD and all the changes were wiped out with a reboot. Well, now we will show you how to get a portable Linux operating system and run it from any computer that can boot from a USB flash device, allowing you to bring your entire operating system, desktop, applications, files, email, personal settings, and more with you. It's like carrying your own personal operating system in your pocket; fully customised, with your own favourite apps and all your settings intact.

No magic trick. We will use this Windows tool called "Universal USB Creator" that makes all this possible. It's a stand alone application that automates the process of downloading, formatting, and installing a Linux OS to a USB drive, as well as imple-

menting a variable amount of persistence. This means when you install new software, change keyboard shortcuts, store files in your home directory, or make other changes to your portable Linux, they stick from boot-up to boot-up — which isn't the case with most portable Linux distributions. Another useful feature that you wish for: your USB drive can still be read by Windows when you're done formatting, so your pen drive is not wasted and you can still use it the old-fashioned way: for storing data!

Download the Universal USB Installer from <http://tinyurl.com/digit0810linux> and 'Run' the executable. Click 'Browse' and open the downloaded ISO file. If you've already downloaded a Linux installation ISO and run Universal USB Installer from

the same directory the ISO is in, the app will find it and use it for the installation, rather than download another copy.

Make sure you select persistence from the drop-down box, else it will be just another Live CD type installation.

UNetbootin is yet another Live USB creation tool that can be used to create a Live Linux flash drive from an ISO. Most of the Linux distributions are supported out of the box with custom install options available for Linux distributions. One bad thing about Unetbootin as compared to Universal USB installer is that the pen drive created using this software is not persistent and all your changes are lost upon reboot. It is just like a Live CD, but works nonetheless. Download UNetbootin from <http://tinyurl.com/digit0810unetbootin> and double-click on the executable file to start it.

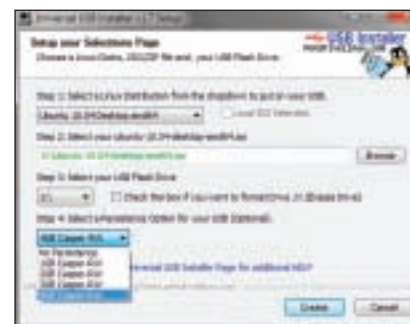
Select the DiskImage radio box and browse using the ... on the right side to select your ISO file on the hard disk. Next, set the target USB drive in the drop down box labelled 3 in our image. Next, click on Ok

and you're done.

First, you need to check under which device node it is associated. Type the following command:

```
$ sudo fdisk -l
```

On our test system, the device appeared as /dev/sdb, we will therefore use /dev/sdb as a reference for this tutorial; you just need to replace it accordingly for your system. Now comes the part where we will make a separate partition for this install. You need to ensure that the already mounted partition is unmounted with `$sudo umount /dev/sdb1` and then launch `fdisk`, a command line software to edit partitions under Linux `sudo fdisk /`



Choose the USB drive and click 'Create'

dev/sdb1. The first partition we will make on our pen drive will be formatted as a FAT file-system of size 16 and this will contain the CD image:

```
$ sudo mkfs.vfat -F 16 -n liveusb /dev/sdb1
```

The second partition should be of type ext2 with a blocksize of 4096 bytes, and labelled as casper-rw. Make sure that it is labeled as casper-rw otherwise this tutorial might not work:

```
$ sudo mkfs.ext2 -b 4096 -L casper-rw /dev/sdb2
```

At this stage, your usb pen-drive is ready to host the liveCD image. You just need to copy the



Select Ubuntu 10.4 Desktop amd64 from the dropdown list